customer, so that while the exchange of notes is taking place, a few seconds elapse which will allow the ink to dry up and prevent removal of ink.'

Customers responded with indignation, while the Election Commission of India (ECI) responded with alarm! The ECI wrote to the MoF not to use indelible ink in banks for marking people, reminding it that five states were going for by-polls on 19 November and raising concerns that this would cause confusion. Meanwhile, as there was only one company[45] in India that made this ink and there wasn't enough ink to meet the demand from lakhs of bank branches, bank staff started using products such as dhobi ink and permanent markers to mark the customers.

The notifications on 'withdrawals for weddings' were even more absurd. The demonetization announcement came at the peak of the wedding season in India, and stranded many families without cash to pay for wedding expenses. Faced with a barrage of media reports, on 17 November, Shaktikanta Das told reporters that families having weddings would be exempted from the general cash limits and would be allowed to withdraw up to ₹2,50,000. The Department of Economic Affairs in the MoF swiftly issued S.O. 3488(E) on 18 November, authorizing such withdrawals.

Then, fearing they may have opened a Pandora's box, the Finance Ministry, on 19 November rolled back the new provisions. It then issued a fresh notification specifying that the withdrawals would be subject to RBI guidelines, which, of course, had not yet been issued.

On 21 November, the RBI finally issued its own notification[46] laying down an incredibly complex procedure to be followed before any cash could be drawn. They had to provide 'Evidence of the wedding, including the invitation card, copies of receipts for advance payments already made, such as marriage hall booking, advance payments to caterers, etc.' The conditions stated that those withdrawing cash for wedding expenses would need to submit 'a detailed list of persons to whom the cash withdrawn is proposed to be